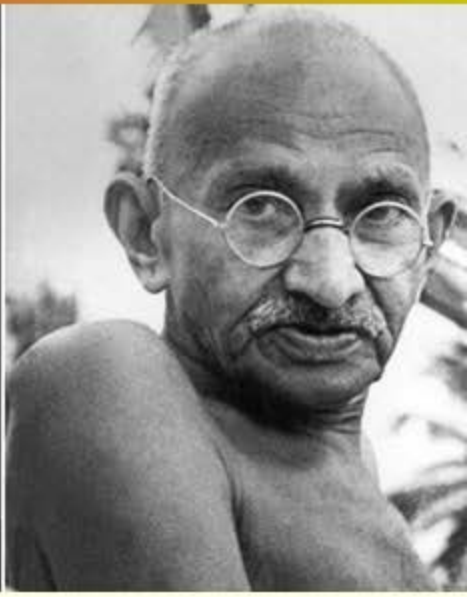


MODERN INDIAN HISTORY



MODULE - 38

EVENTS BETWEEN (1928-1935)
ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE & CDM-PHASE 2

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

Aug, 1928

NEHRU REPORT WAS
FINALISED



Dec, 1928

Old leaders like Motilal Nehru,
Gandhi etc

Young leaders Jawahar Lal Nehru,
Subash Chandra Bose, Satyamurthy

(CALCUTTA
SESSION)

Nehru Report approved

Expressed dissatisfaction with
dominion status as goal of Congress

Dominion status

Complete Independence or Purna
Swaraj

2 years grace period to accept
the demand

Grace period reduced to 1 year

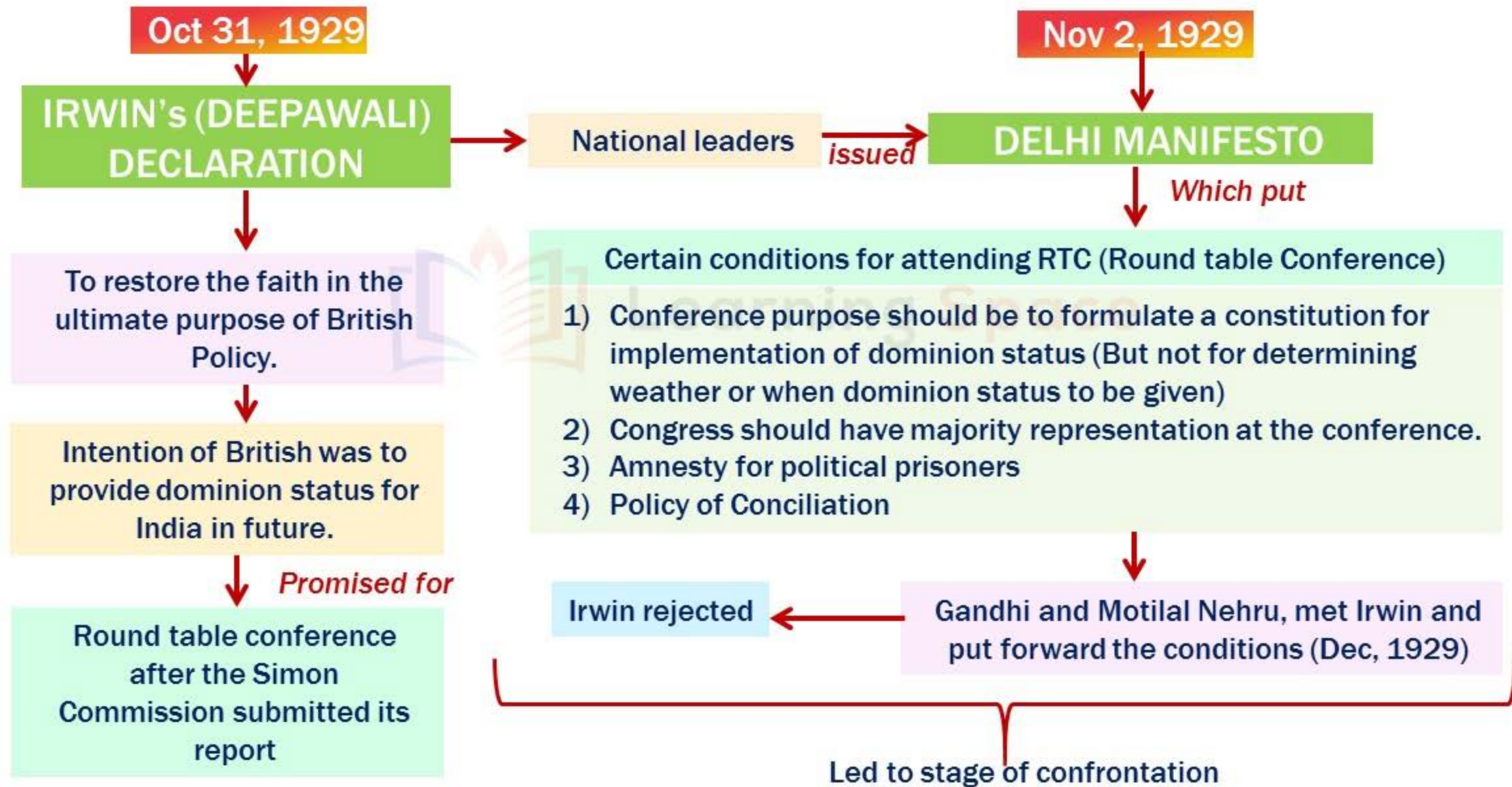


MOTILAL NEHRU
(PRESIDENT)

Congress gave an ultimatum to Government

If dominion status was not approved within a year Congress would not only demand complete independence but also launch CDM to attain its goal

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)



EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

May 1930

SIMON COMMISSION
REPORT

So, **British** government called a conference consisting of the **representatives** of both the **British India** as well as the **Indian states** so as to take a final decision on the issue of constitutional reforms for India.

Accordingly

First Round Table Conference
was called in London in Nov,
1930.

Meanwhile, many attempts were made to persuade Congress to attend RTC

But congress was adamant and stuck to the demand of complete independence. Congress also demanded an independent tribunal to settle all the financial claims of Britain.



Though British Government were proposing to give "Dominion status" to India, but Simon commission did not mention anything about Dominion status.

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

FIRST ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE (NOVEMBER 1930- JANUARY 1931)

Nov 1930 – Jan 1931

FIRST ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE



Almost 89 members attended the First Round Table Conference

Congress did not participate but **other numbers of national parties and princes participated**, the results of the conference were minimal.

The conference ended with the **Indian princess agreeing for a federation** with a weak responsible Central government

- The **absence of Congress representation** in the First Round Table conference **made conference meaningless**.
- So, it was decided to have a second one.

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

FIRST ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE (NOVEMBER 1930- JANUARY 1931)

Political parties, Communities, Princely states and their leaders at First Round Table conference

HINDU MAHASABHA



Mukund Ramrao Jayakar, MS Moonje

SIKHS



Sardar Sampurna Singh

CHRISTIANS



Kanakarayan Tiruselvam Paul

LIBERALS



Tej Bahadur Sapru, C Y Chintamani, Srinivas Shastri

MUSLIM LEAGUE



Aga Khan, Md Shafi, Jinnah, Mohammad Ali, Fazlul Haq

DEPRESSED CLASSES



B R Ambedkar

PRINCESS



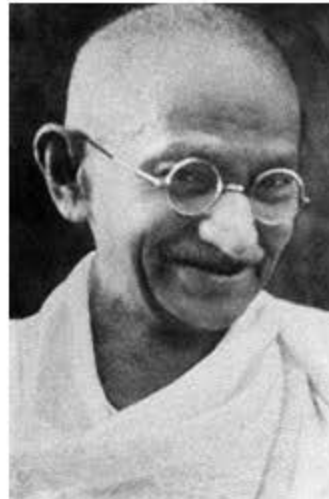
Akbar Hydari (Diwan of Hyderabad), Mirza Ismail (Diwan of Mysore), Maharaja of Bikaner.

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE

FIRST ROUND TABLE
CONFERENCE
(Nov 1930 to Jan 1931)

- Nothing substantial could be reached.
- Ended with Indian princess agreeing for a federation with a weak responsible Central Government
- To bring Congress to 2nd RTC Gandhi-Irwin pact was envisaged.



GANDHI-IRWIN PACT

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

Every delegate in the conference suggested that **constitutional discussion without congress was meaningless.**

Some liberal leaders like Tej Bahadur Sapru, Srinivasa Sastri Sankarannarayana, and Mukund Ramrao Jayakar on their return tried to persuade Gandhiji to join Round table Conference.

Business class extended their support thinking that movement would be short lived. But since it lasted long they were weary of their business interest. So they were persuading Gandhi to go for talks and suspend CDM

The British authorities also wanted congress to join. So to create an appropriate atmosphere, Viceroy released Congress leaders and invited Gandhiji for talks,

Congress authorized Gandhi to initiate discussion

Based on which, pact was signed

GANDHI-IRWIN PACT/DELHI PACT

Pact placed congress on equal footing with British



TEJ BAHADUR SAPRU



SRINIVASA SASTRI

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

GANDHI – IRWIN PACT(5th MARCH, 1931)

In this pact both the side agreed on some demands based on the principle on mutual consensus.

IRWIN ON BEHALF OF THE GOVERNMENT AGREED ON

1. Immediate **release of all political prisoners** not convicted of violence;
2. **Remission of all fines** not yet collected;
3. Return of all lands not yet sold to third parties;
4. Lenient treatment to those government servants who had resigned;
5. Right to **make salt in coastal villages for personal consumption (not for sale)**;
6. **Right to peaceful and non-aggressive picketing**;
7. **Withdrawal of emergency ordinances.**

GANDHI ON BEHALF OF THE INDIAN AGREED

1. To suspend the civil disobedience movement
2. To participate in the Second Round Table Conference for drafting the constitutional reforms on the basis of
 - Federation
 - Responsibility, and
 - reservations and safeguards in the interest of India for such matters as defence, external affairs, position of minorities, financial credit of India.

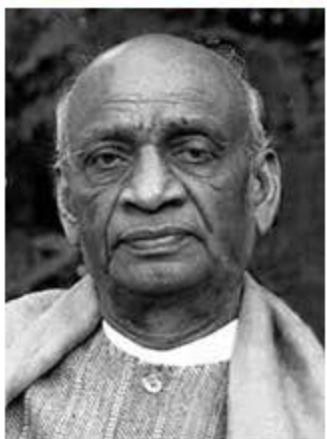
The viceroy turned down 2 of Gandhi's demands

- Public inquiry into police excesses, and
- Commutation of Bhagat Singh and his comrades death sentence to life sentence.

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

KARACHI SESSION

29 Mar,
1931



A SPECIAL SESSION OF THE
CONGRESS WAS HELD AT KARACHI

To

ENDORSE THE GANDHI-IRWIN PACT.

- This session authorized Gandhi to represent congress at the second Round Table conference.
- The goal of Purna swaraj was reiterated
- Two resolutions were adopted.
 - Fundamental rights
 - National economic policy.

PRESIDED BY SARDAR PATEL

- On 23rd March 1929 Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev and Rajguru were executed. Gandhi failed to prevent their execution.
- So throughout Gandhi's route to Karachi, he was greeted with black flag demonstrations by the Punjab Naujawan Bharat Sabha
- In Karachi session Congress admired the 'bravery' and 'sacrifice' of the three martyrs.

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

KARACHI SESSION

2 RESOLUTION WERE
ADOPTED

FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS

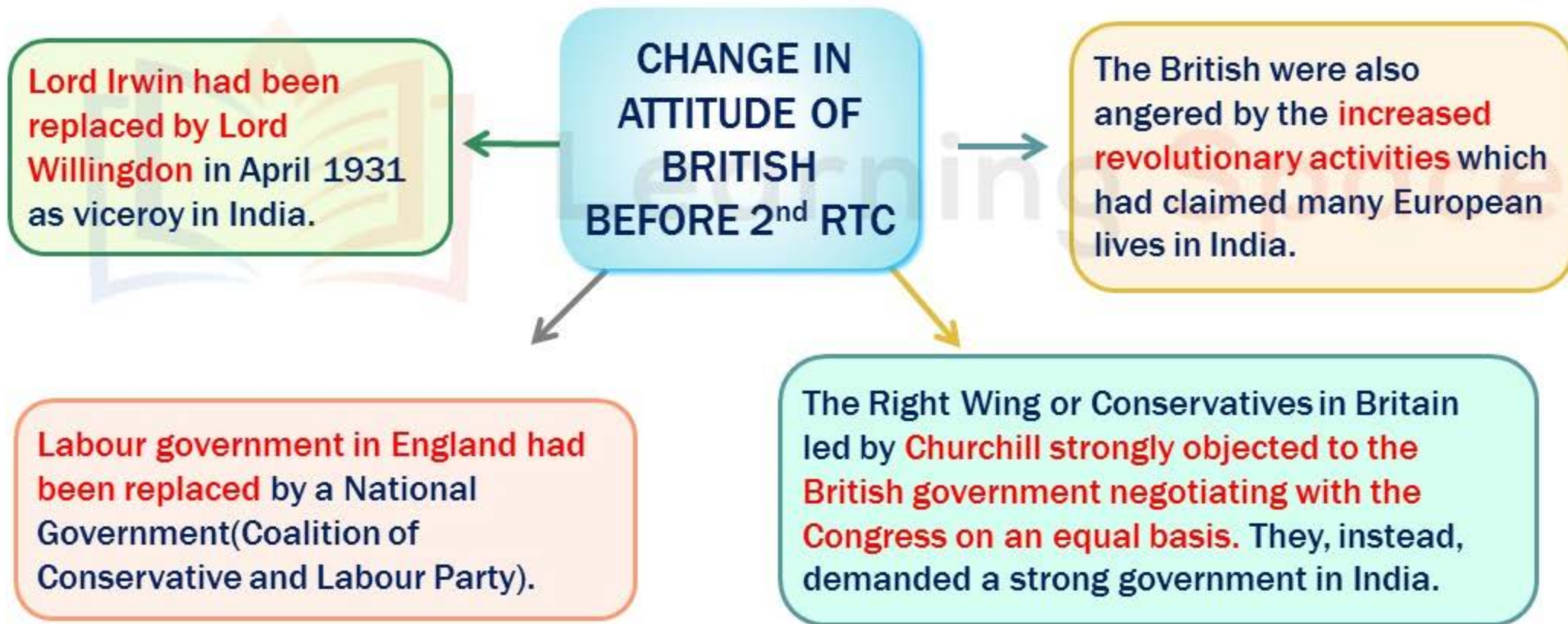
- Equal legal rights irrespective of caste, creed and sex
- Free speech and free press
- Right to assemble
- Right to form associations
- Free and compulsory primary education
- Neutrality of state in religious matters
- Protection to culture, language, script of minorities and linguistic groups
- Universal adult franchise

NATIONAL ECONOMIC PROGRAMME

- Substantial reduction in rent and revenue in the case of landholders and peasants
- Exemption from rent for uneconomic holdings
- Relief from agricultural indebtedness

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE MOVEMENT- SUSPENDED



LORD WILLINGDON (1931- 1936)



LORD WILLINGDON
(1931- 1936)

1931

- Second round table conference
- Resumption of civil disobedience movement

1932

- Announcement of communal award
- Poona pact
- Third round table conference

1933

Civil disobedience movement phase-2

1934

Kanpur-Bolshevik Conspiracy
Congress socialist party

1935

Government of India act 1935
Burma separated from India

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

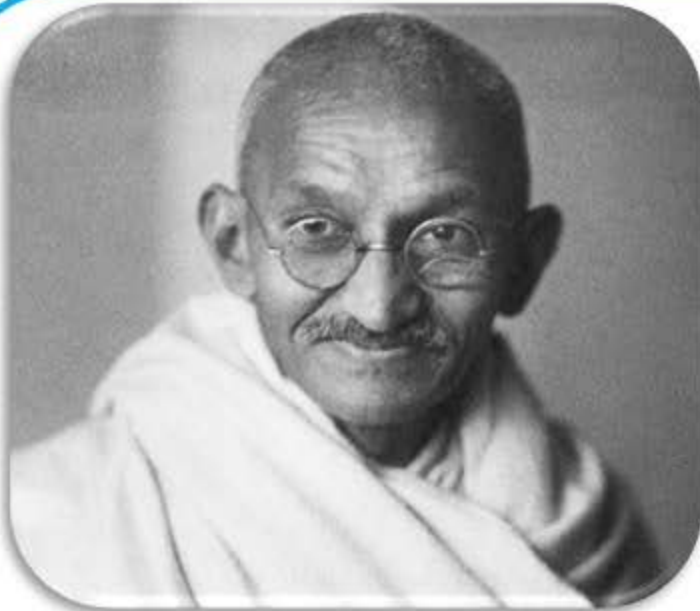
SECOND ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE (SEPTEMBER - DECEMBER 1931)

Mar, 1931

A SPECIAL SESSION OF THE
CONGRESS WAS HELD AT KARACHI

Authorized Gandhi to represent
congress at the 2nd RTC

Gandhi represented Indian National Congress and Sarojini Nayudu represented Indian women.



MAHATAMA GANDHI



SAROJINI NAIDU

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

SECOND ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE (SEPTEMBER - DECEMBER 1931)

This conference saw an **overwhelming number of Indian delegates** including included loyalists, communalists, careerists, big landlords, representatives of the princes and others

The main points put forward by Gandhi included:

→ The partnership between Britain and India should be in terms of **two equal nations**.

→ Responsible government both at the center and provinces.

→ A **Congress alone represented political India**

→ The untouchables were Hindus and should not be treated as a **"minority"**,

→ No separate electorates or special safeguards for Muslims or other minorities.

- Many delegates who mainly include loyalist, conservatives and communalist opposed it.
- Accordingly Government rejected Congress claim of representing the interests of all India.

Talks broke down with respect to minority issue.

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

SECOND ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE (SEPTEMBER - DECEMBER 1931)

Soon deadlocked was reached on the **question of the minorities**. All minorities {except Sikhs} such as Muslims, Dalits, Christians, Anglo-Indians, Europeans **demanded separate electorates**. And all these came together in a “minorities pact”



The conference ended with **Ramsay Macdonald (British PM)** announcing the formation of 2 new Muslim majority province NWFP and Sindh.



No agreed solution could be reached on issues put forward by Gandhi. Gandhi returned empty handed and resumed civil disobedience.

CHANGED ATTITUDE AFTER 2nd RTC?

We can see a changed attitude in British:

1. **British were now convinced that goodwill of the Congress was not required**, but the confidence of those who supported the British against the Congress government functionaries, loyalists, etc. was very essential.
2. They wanted to weaken Gandhi and congress and **prevent them from building up the tempo for a mass movement again**.
3. Their implicit objective was to create **division in nationalistic lines by supporting some sections against congress**.

EVENTS DURING (1928-1935)

ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE

FIRST ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE (Nov 1930 to Jan 1931)

- Nothing substantial could be reached.
- Ended with Indian princess agreeing for a federation with a weak responsible Central Government
- Congress did not participate.

SOUND ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE (Sep 1931 to Dec 1931)

- Congress attended the meeting
- On the failure of the **2nd RTC, CWC decided to resume the Civil disobedience movement on December 29, 1931.**



SECOND ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE MOVEMENT-2ND PHASE-(1931-1934)

28, Dec,
1931

Gandhi returned from London

He immediately resumed CDM

4, Jan,
1932

Congress leaders including
Gandhi, Sardar were arrested

- Congress and its allied organization were declared illegal.
- Offices and funds of the parties were seized.
- All Ashrams of Gandhi were occupied by Police.

- The government dealt the movement with rough hand.
- Government promulgated ordinances which gave authorities unlimited power **virtually imposing "civil martial law"** (i.e. declaring military rule)

- Protest started all over India.
- Picketing the liquor shops, burning of foreign cloths and processions continued.

Though there was official ban on congress still they held Delhi congress session (April 1932) and Calcutta congress session (march 1933)

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE MOVEMENT-2ND PHASE-(1931-1934)

16th, Aug,
1932

Ramsay Macdonald (British PM) announced communal award

After this the strength and the pace of CDM began to decline.

20th, Sep,
1932

Gandhi announced fast unto death

Against communal award which proposed to give separate electorate to untouchables.

25th, Sep,
1932

Poona pact was signed between Gandhi and Ambedkar

Government accepted the pact as amendment to Communal award.

In the background of communal award and Gandhi's fast on to death CDM lost its momentum. After the Poona pact, Gandhi lost interest in the movement and only involved in anti-untouchability struggle

CDM was finally withdrawn in May 1934 by Gandhi.

In summary, by communal award, the British were successful in diverting attention from Civil Disobedience Movement and created a dissension among the Hindus.

EVENTS DURING (1928-1935)

ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE

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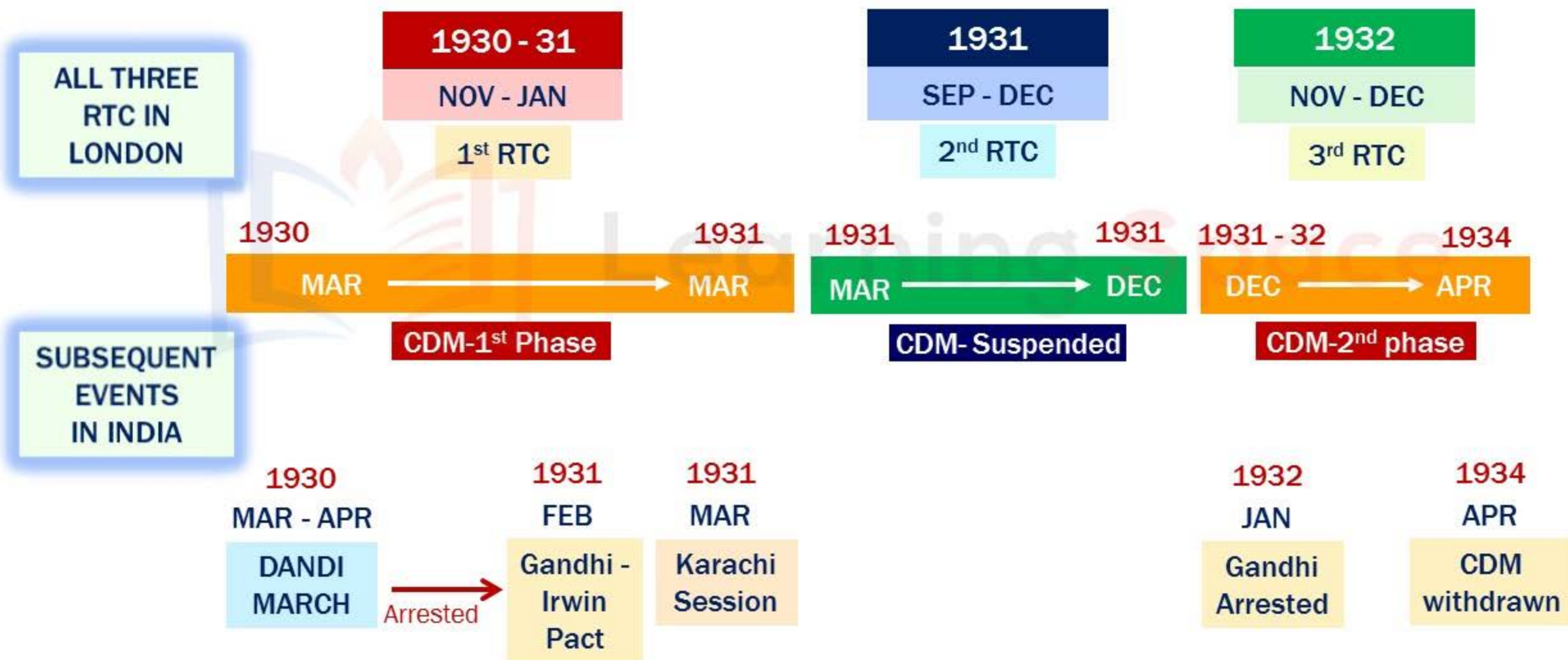
- Congress attended the meeting
- On the failure of the **2nd RTC, CWC decided to resume the Civil disobedience movement on December 29, 1931.**

THIRD ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE (Nov 1932 to Dec 1932)

- Congress boycotted it. Only 46 delegates attended.
- Prominent members Tej bahadur Sapru and B.R.Ambedkar (both attended all 3 RTC)

At the end of this conference, a White Paper was released on the basis of which the Government of India Act, 1935 was drafted.

QUICK RECAP OF CDM



COURSE OF CDM

STRUGGLE - TRUCE - STRUGGLE

Phase of Mass Movement

Phase of Reprieve

Phase of Mass Movement



MAHATAMA GANDHI

1

Enable the masses to recoup their strength to fight

as

Masses cannot go on sacrificing indefinitely

2

Giving Government a chance and time to respond to the demands

If the response is not positive the movement could be resumed again with mass participation

COURSE OF CDM

NEHRU'S OPPOSITION TO STS STRATEGY



J L NEHRU

NEHRU

Rejected

STS STRATEGY

WHY?

1. After the call for Purna Swaraj there should be **continuous confrontation and conflict** until the imperialism is overthrown.
2. "Advocated – "Continuous direct Action" polity by congress
3. Instead of STS strategy he proposed SV strategy (Struggle Victory)

COURSE OF CDM

3 EPISODE - CDM

1st EPISODE

March – September, 1930

- ✓ High bourgeois participation in towns.
- ✓ Peasant mobilization in villages on issues like
 - Salt tax
 - No revenue
 - No chaukidari tax
 - Picketing of liquor

2nd EPISODE

Oct – 1930 to Mar - 1931

- ✓ Decline in participation of urban bourgeoisie (Merchants) and industrialists by them)
- ✓ Attempts to bring compromise between Congress and Government which resulted into Congress – Irwin Pact of March 1931

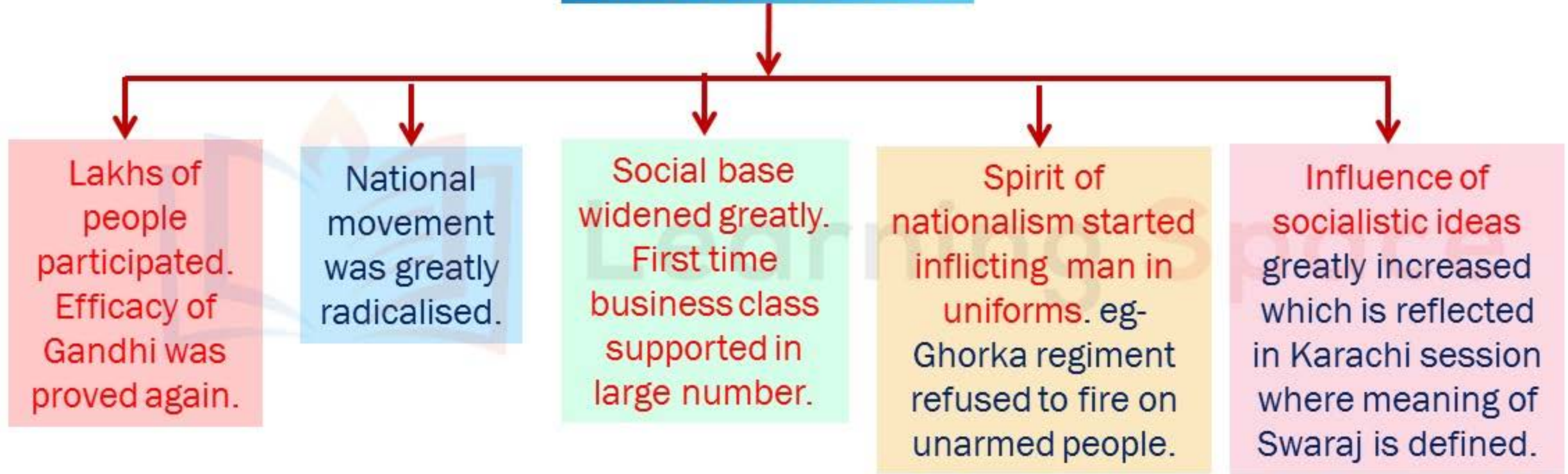
3rd EPISODE

Jan – 1932 to April - 1934

- ✓ Saw ruthless repression practiced by Government on people and eventual withdrawal by Congress

EVENTS DURING (1928-1935)

SIGNIFICANCE CDM



The movement eliminated any possibility of conciliation as fight against British rule has reached a point of no return because the movement began with demand of Purna swaraj.

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